

Mammal facts

The first mammals evolved 220 million years ago, when dinosaurs dominated the Earth. Today, mammals have adapted to live almost everywhere and are spread all over the world, from grasslands and rainforests to icy poles and deep oceans.

WHAT IS A MAMMAL?



Vertebrates

Although they may look different, all mammals have an internal skeleton that is made of bone.



Warm-blooded

Mammals maintain a stable body temperature, whether they are in a hot or cold environment.



Live young

Most mammals give birth to live young, rather than hatching from eggs like birds.



Drink milk

Young mammals feed on milk from their mother, which provides vital nutrients for their growth.



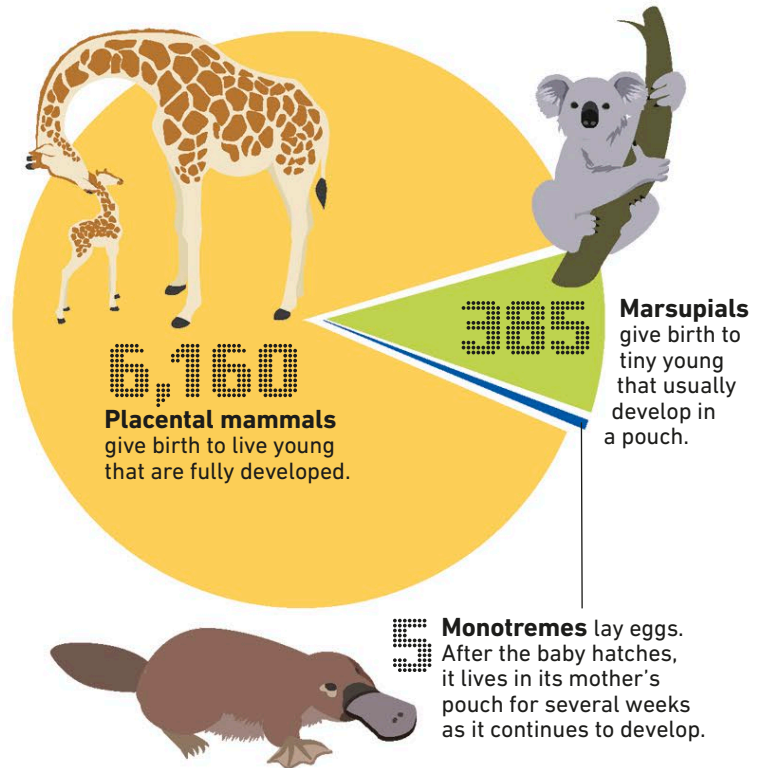
Hair

Mammals have fur, spines, or scales to trap heat. Marine mammals have insulating blubber.

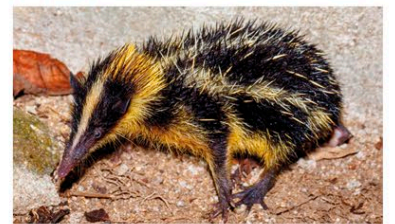
MAMMAL TYPES

ESTIMATED NUMBER OF MAMMAL SPECIES:

6,550



THE **TAILLESS TENREC** OF **MADAGASCAR** CAN HAVE UP TO **32** **BABIES** IN ONE LITTER.



EXTREME HABITATS

Some hardy mammals have adapted to survive in extremely hot, cold, or rather odd places.



Musk oxen use their hooves to dig through snow and find edible plants in temperatures below freezing. They live mainly in the tundra regions of Greenland and Arctic North America.



Kangaroo rats have adapted to live in the extreme heat of the deserts in the western US and Mexico. This rodent does not drink water, instead getting moisture from desert grass seeds.



Goats can grip tiny crevices with their hooves, allowing them to ascend a vertical cliff safely. These rock-climbing goats are in Greece, but this mammal can be found all over the world.

INDONESIA IS HOME TO

291 MAMMAL SPECIES

MORE THAN ANY OTHER **COUNTRY.**

